Lewis & Clark Trail Adventures

2026 Lolo Trail Condition Assessment Report

Findings and Recommendations for Annual Maintenance and Reconstruction

Lewis and Clark National Historic Trail, Trail #25 · Glade Creek to the Weippe Prairie



Field assessment	**September 24–27, 2026**
Prepared for	Lewis & Clark Trail Alliance · Lolo Reconnected
Assessment team	Wayne Fairchild (lead), Chad Jones, Cody Dudgeon, Drew Reeve, Laurie Rudd
Date	September 2026

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Summary

Between September 24 and 27, 2026, five guides from Lewis & Clark Trail Adventures (LCTA) walked and scouted Lewis and Clark Trail #25 from Glade Creek, near Lolo Pass, west toward the Weippe Prairie. Richard Hunt, Director of the Lewis & Clark Trail Alliance, asked us to take on the assessment to help plan the Alliance's 2027 work projects and to support the Lolo Reconnected effort. The timing matters: windstorms over the last several years have put thousands of trees across Trail #25 and USFS Road 500.

About half of the route is in good shape or close to it. The rest ranges from buried or intermittent tread to stretches where we could find no trail at all. In short:

- Trail markers and segment signs are the most common need, and the easiest to fix. Several of the best access points, including Lolo Pass, Powell and Lochsa Lodge, and Wilderness Gateway, are hard to follow without them. The interpretive signage along the corridor, by contrast, is in good condition and has been updated and maintained through the summer of 2026.
- A number of segments could be fully opened by a volunteer crew in a day or two, among them the Glade Creek connector, White Sand Creek to Wendover, and Lewis and Clark Grove to Small Prairie.
- The roughest segments, such as Lonesome Cove to Howard Camp, Willow Ridge to Hungery Creek, and Bald Mountain to Dry Camp, will need paid crews with certified sawyers and someone who knows where the historic route runs.
- Finishing the corridor will take partners. Checkerboard land ownership, Road 500 access, and ongoing trail work by others, likely including the Nez Perce Tribe, all point to a partnership. That partnership, working as a cohesive team, is likely to include the U.S. Forest Service, the Tribe and other public and private organizations, businesses, and landowners who all coexist in the area.

We compared our findings with Charles (Chuck) Raddon's September 2026 condition survey of the Nee-Me-Poo Trail, prepared for Lolo Reconnected. Where the two routes overlap, his ratings and ours largely agree. The sections that follow rate each segment, say whether it suits volunteers or a paid crew, and list projects ready for funding and scheduling.

1. Introduction

Letter from Owner and Operator of Lewis & Clark Trail Adventures

> *During the summer trail work projects on the Lolo Trail, sponsored by the Lewis & Clark Trail Alliance, Richard Hunt, Director of the Alliance asked me if we would be interested in doing a trail assessment for next summer's work projects. I gladly accepted the offer.*
>
> *My name is Wayne Fairchild, owner and operator of Lewis & Clark Trail Adventures, Established in 1989. During the last 37 years of outfitting on the Lolo trail I have seen many changes to the trail and USFS Rd 500. However, in the past two years we have seen more extreme windstorms, causing thousands of trees to block the road #500 and the Lewis & Clark trail #25. To better assess, I and four guides started at Lolo Pass "Glade Creek" and ended at Weippe, ID on Sept 24-27, 2026.*
>
> *This trail assessment report provides an evaluation of the physical condition of the trail #25 from Glade Creek to Weippe Prairie. The task was to identify the maintenance needs that can be addressed by volunteer work groups and paid professional trail crews. We created a scale number system that identifies the condition of trails rated 1-5. We separated the trail into sections that will be provided in the report.*
>
> *The crew members:*
>
> 1. *Chad Jones*
> 2. *Cody Dudgeon*
> 3. *Drew Reeve*
> 4. *Laurie Rudd*
>
> *We hope this project helps support the Lolo Reconnected mission, raise awareness of our shared history, and make the trail more accessible.*
>
> *Proceed On,*
>
> *Wayne Fairchild · Outfitter & Guide Lewis & Clark Trail Adventures*

Assessment team

Wayne Fairchild, (team lead). Owner and operator of Lewis & Clark Trail Adventures since 1989, with 37 years of outfitting on the Lolo Trail. Wayne graduated from the University of Montana in 1989 with a degree in Recreation Management. Before that, in 1984, he served in the U.S. Army's 509th Airborne Battalion in Vicenza, Italy. Contact: fairchildwayne@gmail.com, (406) 529-0069

Chad Jones, Guide, holds a master's degree in Physical Anthropology from the University of Montana. While in graduate school, he began working for Lewis & Clark Trail Adventures, where he developed a deep passion for the Lolo Trail and the story of Lewis and Clark in the West. For years, Chad and Wayne spent their free time exploring and bushwhacking along the trail, searching for remnants of its historic tread and working to rediscover the original route. Though Chad has since left the West, he returns each year for his pilgrimage up Wendover Ridge, drawn back by the history, solitude and enduring beauty of the Lolo Trail. Contact: jchadjones1@gmail.com, (406) 396-0196

Cody Dudgeon, Guide, is the owner and operator of Desert River Guides, based in Farmington, New Mexico, and brings nearly two decades of trail and river guiding experience to the team. A graduate of the University of Montana, he teaches Advanced Placement social studies in Farmington, where he also leads classes in bicycle mechanics. Cody teaches with real heart, and the warmth and enthusiasm he brings to the classroom have earned him the deep affection of his students. For this assessment, he logged waypoints and walked tracks in onX. Contact: codyrafts@gmail.com, (406) 207-3581

Drew Reeve, Guide, is a traditionally trained economist and data/software engineer, with degrees in Economics, Political Science and International Studies and a Master of Science in International Affairs and Global Enterprise (MIAGE) from the University of Utah. He also holds a Master of Science in Software Engineering from the University of Advancing Technology. A recent move to Missoula, Montana, to explore PhD research has inspired and invigorated his interest in the Lolo Trail and the history of Lewis and Clark. For this assessment, he recorded field GPS data and compiled the final written report and trail inventory. Contact: drew.reeve@gmail.com, (435) 232-1617

Laurie Rudd, Guide, is an educator on the Lewis and Clark Expedition and the broader history of the region. Her passion for the Lolo Trail and its place in the history of the Pacific Northwest shows in every group she teaches, as she brings the story of this landscape to life for learners of all ages. In her words: "After this experience in the Bitterroots, my appreciation, understanding, and comprehension of the route Lewis and Clark's band took through this range has completely transformed. What was ambiguous and overwhelming is now comprehensible and accessible. Immersing myself in it I found clarity and a deep appreciation for the section of trail through Idaho." Contact: lars.rudd@gmail.com, (208) 201-7656



The 2026 assessment team at camp along the Lolo Trail, September 2026. From left to right: Cody, Laurie, Wayne, Drew and Chad.

2. Approach and Strategy

Objectives

1. Record the condition of Trail #25 from Glade Creek to the Weippe Prairie after the 2025–26 windstorms.
2. Identify maintenance and reconstruction needs, and whether volunteer groups or paid trail crews are better suited to each.
3. Note who else is working in the corridor and the land-ownership issues that affect access.
4. Give the Lewis & Clark Trail Alliance a prioritized project list for 2027 planning and funding requests.

Field methods

We traveled west from Lolo Pass over four days, September 24–27, 2026, using Road 500 for access. We broke the route into segments between known campsites, junctions and access points, then walked or scouted each one we could reach, often splitting up to cover more ground. Along the way we noted tread condition, downfall, trail markers and posts, flagging or other signs of recent work, and hazards such as failing bridges.

Drew Reeve and Cody Dudgeon logged waypoints, notes and tracks in onX, about 115 waypoints between them; Cody's walked tracks alone cover roughly 3.6 miles between Powell and the Wendover cabin. Chad Jones added Strava tracks from his own hikes in July and September 2026, and Laurie Rudd kept detailed field notes, especially for 13 Mile Camp, Spirit Revival Ridge and the western segments. The coordinates in this report come from those records (Appendix B).



Planning the day's route over a Forest Service map during the assessment, September 2026.

Several of us have guided on the Lolo Trail for years. Wayne Fairchild and Chad Jones scouted much of the route in earlier seasons, including attempts on the Lonesome Cove segment in 2004–05, and that experience shaped where we looked.

Condition ratings

Each segment is rated 1 to 5 based on what we saw in September 2026. Ratings may change after winter blowdown.

Rating	Condition	Typical treatment
1	Clear, established tread; easy to follow	Trail markers and routine annual maintenance
2	Tread present with minor blowdown or confusing junctions	Light logout and brushing; small volunteer crew, part of a day
3	Tread intermittent or partly buried; significant blowdown	Skilled volunteers with a certified sawyer
4	Route flagged or marked, but little or no usable tread	Multi-day crew with sawyers; tread reconstruction
5	No trail or tread located; cross-country travel only	Route location survey, then a professional construction crew

These ratings line up closely with the scale Chuck Raddon uses in his Lolo Reconnected survey: 1, clear and maintained yearly; 2, light downfall, fewer than three per mile; 3, significant downfall, passable by scrambling; 4, heavy downfall requiring major effort; 5, no existing tread. We suggest both efforts use his definitions going forward. Both scales run opposite to the Forest Service Trail Class system, where Class 1 is the least developed, so we call ours a condition rating to avoid confusion.

What we mean by signage

Interpretive signage along the corridor is generally in good shape. Much of it has been updated and maintained through the summer of 2026, and we are not recommending work on it. When this report refers to signage or trail markers, it means route marking only: posts and blazes, junction markers, and signs giving a trail segment's name and length.

Crew types

- **Volunteer:** a typical volunteer group with hand tools.
- **Skilled volunteer:** volunteers working with certified sawyers, or a multi-day commitment.
- **Professional:** a paid trail crew with certified sawyers and tread-building experience, led by a guide or archaeologist who can locate the historic route.

Limitations

This was a rapid assessment, not a formal survey. We saw some segments only in part or from the road, and route locations on segments rated 5 are not confirmed. No heritage, land-status or environmental review has been done, and those may be needed before any ground-disturbing work.

Supporting sources

Two 2026 works by Charles Raddon, who managed recreation, wilderness and trails on the Clearwater National Forest beginning in 1988, informed this report:

- *The Lolo Trail Riding and Hiking Trail* condition report (Lolo Reconnected, September 2026), which rates the Nee-Me-Poo / Bird-Truax ridgeline route (USFS Trail #40) in 18 legs over roughly 100 miles, from Musselshell Meadows to Lee Creek Campground.
- *A History Buff's Guide to the Lolo Trail Corridor* (June 2026), with site histories, GPS locations and trail notes.

Our assessment follows the Lewis and Clark route (Trail #25), including the Lochsa River and Wendover Ridge sections his survey does not cover. The two routes share much of the ridgeline between Willow Ridge and Rocky Point, and Section 3.3 compares them directly.

3. Segment Summary and Findings

3.1 Segment summary

Segments are listed west-bound, following the expedition's September 1805 route. Condition ratings use the scale in Section 2.



Figure 1. Overview of the assessed route from Lolo Pass to Pheasant Camp, with the principal historic camps and landmarks. The route line is simplified; segment conditions and field GPS details are in Sections 3.1 and 3.2 and Appendix B.

For orientation, Laurie Rudd traced the expedition's sequence through the assessed area as follows. She notes that several camps are still missing from this sequence and need to be located in the field.

- **1805 westbound:** Wendover → Snowbank → Cayuse Junction → Lonesome Cove → Sinque Hole → Indian Grave → Smoking Place → Dry Camp → Spirit Revival → Sherman Saddle → Willow Ridge → Hungery Creek → FS 485/500 junction → Full Stomach Camp → Salmon Trout → Small Prairie → Lewis and Clark Grove → Lolo Creek Trailhead → Pheasant Camp → Browns Ridge → Weippe Prairie
- **1806 eastbound (where the route differs):** Bald Mountain → Bears Oil and Roots → Imnamatnoon Junction → 13 Mile Camp → Rocky Point Lookout

Segment	Condition	Workforce	Primary need
Lolo Pass to Glade Creek	1 (overlook), 4–5 (to glade)	Volunteer	Tread restoration and light logout, ~1/8 mile
Glade Creek to Colt Killed Creek	5	Partnership	Landowner, USFS and tribal coordination
Colt Killed Creek to Powell Ranger Station	1–2	Volunteer	Signage; light clearing
Powell Ranger Station to Wendover Trailhead	1–2	Volunteer	Signage; ~12 tree cuts; bridge safety updates
Wendover Ridge to Snowbank	1	Annual maintenance	Monitor for 2027 blowdown

Segment	Condition	Workforce	Primary need
Snowbank area, 13 Mile, Rocky Point	3–5	Partnership / professional	Coordinate with groups active in the area
Snowbank to Cayuse Junction	5	Professional	Route location survey
Cayuse Junction to Lonesome Cove	5	Professional	Locate and construct 4–5 miles
Lonesome Cove to Howard Camp	5	Professional	Locate and construct ~4 miles
Howard Camp to Sinque Hole	Unclear (follows Road 500)	Agency decision	Trail alongside road, or road designated as route
Sinque Hole to Smoking Place	1	Volunteer	Signage
Bears Oil and Roots / Spring Hill Mountain (eastbound)	3–4	Skilled volunteer	Sawyer logout; 2-day ridge project
Smoking Place / Sinque Hole to Dry Camp	4–5	Skilled volunteer	Uncover buried tread
Dry Camp to Upper Spirit Revival	1	Annual maintenance	Trail markers; annual upkeep
Lower Spirit Revival (Sherman Creek) to Lochsa River	1	Volunteer	Signage
Spirit Revival to Sherman Saddle	5	Professional	Route location survey
Sherman Saddle to Sherman Peak	2 (Raddon) / not located by team	Scouting	Confirm route; signage
Sherman Saddle to Willow Ridge	2–3	Volunteer	Signage
Willow Ridge to Hungery Creek	5	Professional	Multi-day survey and construction
Hungery Creek area	5	Professional	Confirm historic route
Full Stomach Camp / Dollar Creek	1 (first ½ mile), then 5	Professional	Sawyers and tread construction
Small Prairie to Lewis and Clark Grove	3–4	Volunteer + professional (bridge)	Clearing, signage, bridge near Clark's Tree
Lewis and Clark Grove to Pheasant Camp	1	Annual maintenance	Maintained in 2026
Pheasant Camp to Weippe Prairie	Not assessed	—	Assess on a future trip

3.2 Detailed findings by segment



Lolo Pass to Glade Creek

Condition rating: 1 to the overlook; 4–5 beyond. The tourist section at Lolo Pass is in good shape, with an accessible trail to the overlook. About a mile down, a good sign and a marked path point toward the glade, but the trail itself is overgrown. We found flagging and spray paint on trees and don't know who placed them. Near the glade, Cody found a downed signpost too rotted to read, with very old flagging nearby. Raddon's guide notes that Ralph Space's Glade Creek Camp is marked only by an old wooden Forest Service sign on FS 5670

(Pack Creek Road) and a short user-made trail, which may explain the informal marking.

RECOMMENDATION. Rake out a tread and clear a few downed trees over about an eighth of a mile. A volunteer group could do this in a morning or an afternoon.

Glade Creek to Colt Killed Creek



Condition rating: 5. We found no trail between Glade Creek and Colt Killed Creek, or from White Sand Creek to 21 Mile. The land here is a checkerboard of public and private ownership. Near Crooked Fork we passed houses and active construction on private land, and a well-developed, gated private road runs close to the mapped trail. One parcel there appeared to be for sale, which may be worth exploring as an easement or partnership opportunity.

Raddon rates the parallel ridgeline route a 5 as well (Legs 16–17). Importantly, he notes that the Forest Service secured rights-of-way across the private parcels within the past 15 years, so the agency should have records. He also points out that Road 500 west of Rocky Point Lookout has been gated since the 1970s and could serve as the trail if it stays closed to private vehicles. Laurie found flagging running from the lookout down the ridge toward 21 Mile, which could be a starting point for relocating this segment.

RECOMMENDATION. Reopening this stretch depends on bringing private landowners, the Forest Service and tribal partners to the table.

Colt Killed Creek to Powell Ranger Station (Lochsa Lodge)



Condition rating: 1–2. Trail #25 is in good condition here, and Drew rated the stretch near Colt Killed Creek a 1, but it is hard to follow without trail markers, especially at its western end. The trail breaks onto a road leading to the neighborhood above Lochsa Lodge, then crosses the Powell Ranger Station road at its entrance. A second access point near Dumpster Drive, farther into the Powell area, was noted but not rated. The ranger station sits on the site of the expedition's September 14, 1805 "Colt Killed Camp." Chad Jones has an additional waypoint and notes for the trail near White Sand Creek.

RECOMMENDATION. A small volunteer group could clean and clear this section. New trail markers would make a big difference at one of the most accessible points on the route, and Lochsa Lodge staff and guests could help promote it.

Powell Ranger Station to Wendover Trailhead







Condition rating: 1–2, then 1. The trail meets the Powell road a couple hundred feet in from Highway 12. Existing trail markers are in poor shape, and the route gets confusing where it crosses private land and roads. From there it follows Highway 12 west to the Wendover area, where Wayne holds Forest Service access to a cabin also used for Lochsa whitewater trips.

Cody walked about 3.6 miles of this section on September 27, from Powell to the Wendover cabin. The tread is visible and well kept in places, but a side-cut stretch is buried in debris and heavy downfall hides the tread beyond it. The trail climbs to cross Highway 12 onto a gated two-track, splits off as single track at a trail marker about 30 feet from the road, crosses a road to a creek bridge, and continues to the cabin, where it crosses to the campground. Nothing marks the trail heading west from there. Where it crosses Highway 12, Drew rated it about a 2.

Most of the historic downriver trail was lost when Highway 12 was built. For the Bicentennial, the Forest Service built a replacement trail to Wendover Ridge that starts just before the Powell Campground gate (Raddon). The bridge at the entrance to Wendover Ridge, which we believe was built by a conservation corps crew, is new and in good condition, but it can be tricky to cross and may need minor safety improvements or updates; Drew Reeve has photos.

> **RECOMMENDATION.** Clear, consistent trail markers throughout, roughly a dozen tree cuts, and light clearing. An average volunteer group could finish it in an afternoon, and minor safety updates to the bridge would make a good volunteer project.

Wendover Ridge to Snowbank







Condition rating: 1. This climb of about 7.5 miles gains roughly 3,300 feet; our GPS read 3,298 feet at the trailhead and 6,574 at Road 500, close to Raddon's figures. Lewis & Clark Trail Adventures' 2026 work opened it up well, and it is used for guided trips. Chad's July hike from the trailhead to Road 500 took a little over seven hours, a realistic planning time for groups and crews.

RECOMMENDATION. Little to no work needed; minor downfall may need clearing in 2027.

Snowbank Camp, 13 Mile and Rocky Point







Condition rating: 3–5. Between the top of Wendover Ridge and Snowbank, away from the road, the route is flagged but mostly without tread. Near Snowbank, Cody found no tread or blazes where

onX shows the Nee-Me-Poo Trail, though flagging heads up the ridgeline. From Snowbank toward Lost Lakes and Powell Junction, the route is marked in places but has little tread, and Snowbank east to Powell Junction has no posts, markers or tread; the road is the only practical route today. Raddon rates this stretch of ridgeline 4–5 throughout (Legs 14–15) and notes that the actual September 15, 1805 camp was likely on the ridge northwest of the Snowbank interpretive sign.

The picture improves around 13 Mile Camp, where Laurie and Cody covered the trail in both directions:

- **West to Imnamatnoon Junction.** The trail is clearly marked with good tread at both ends, but no one has hiked the interior yet. If it is passable, it would make an easy volunteer project needing only light maintenance and trail markers.
- **East toward Rocky Point.** Good tread climbs a ridgeline to Road 500, then continues across the road on a recently cut and flagged section. According to the Rocky Point Lookout staff, the Nez Perce Tribe has been maintaining it. It is easy to follow until it rejoins Road 500, where the trail is lost for a stretch.
- **At the Rocky Point Lookout turnoff.** Flagging runs both ways from the road. Westward it fades out, leaving a gap back to the tribal work. Eastward it is good all the way to the lookout, then past it to the point overlooking Colt Killed Creek and down the ridge toward 21 Mile.

We saw orange-and-black striped flagging from 13 Mile down to Rocky Point Lookout. The ranger at the lookout thought it may belong to the Nez Perce Tribe, which we still need to confirm. Other recent work around 13 Mile and Rocky Point may involve the Idaho Trails Association or a conservation corps crew. The 13 Mile trail also crosses privately owned Section 21, where the Forest Service holds a right-of-way (Raddon).

> **RECOMMENDATION.** Find out who is working here and coordinate with them. The section needs surveying and marking, professional sawyers and trail markers, and partnering with the groups already on the ground is the fastest way to get there.

Snowbank to Cayuse Junction







Condition rating: 5. We found nothing heading west and some flagging heading east; Chad Jones has photos and notes from this stretch. Raddon reports that between the Indian Post Office, Spring Mountain and Cayuse Junction, old trail is visible crossing Road 500 in many places and about four miles could probably be recovered. He recommends flagging and mapping the old trail before deciding what to keep and what to build new,

and cautions against reusing the draw near Cayuse Junction that the original motorway abandoned because it would not drain.

Cayuse Junction to Lonesome Cove



Condition rating: 5. There is no flagging here; it is a bushwhack, and the exact route is uncertain. The Nez Perce have flagged and marked near the Indian Post Office on Road 500, where the Nee-Me-Poo Trail already runs, and tribal members reopened and now maintain the section from Moon Saddle to the Post Office (Raddon). Opening four to five miles from the Post Office to Lonesome Cove would tie into that work.

Drew, Cody and Chad each recorded Lonesome Cove Camp in the same spot, about 0.3 miles from the Indian Post Office, with a cut trail leading down to it; Chad's loop from the Post Office to the camp and back was 1.2 miles. Raddon places the actual camp in the hollow below Moon Saddle, so the historic location is worth settling with Forest Service heritage staff.

RECOMMENDATION. A paid crew with a knowledgeable guide. This is not a job for an average volunteer group.

Lonesome Cove to Howard Camp



Condition rating: 5. Wayne and Chad tried this stretch in 2004–05 and ended up walking out along the creek bed, about four miles. Cody looked for a route near Howard Camp this year and found no trace of one. Research in the 1990s concluded that the expedition left Lonesome Cove by climbing to Moon Saddle and then followed the ridge west to Howard Camp, which puts the historic route on Raddon's Leg 11 rather than in the creek. Raddon flags holding a sustainable grade down to Moon Saddle as a design concern.

RECOMMENDATION. A paid crew with a knowledgeable guide.

Howard Camp to Saddle Camp to Sinque Hole

Condition rating: unclear. The route mostly follows Road 500. A trail runs alongside or crosses the road in places but is not obvious, and the historic line is hard to trace. Raddon fills in some detail: parts of Saddle Camp to Howard Camp were opened by tribal members, the first 0.9 miles is heavily blown down, and the section from Devil's Chair to the Howard Camp sign still needs flagging; a Forest Service archaeologist worked on it around 2023–24. For Sinque Hole to Saddle Camp, he proposes three new pieces of trail that would keep it above the road.

RECOMMENDATION. Decide whether to build trail alongside the road, using Raddon's proposal as a starting point, or to mark the road itself as the route. Either way, clear trail markers are essential.

Sinque Hole to Smoking Place

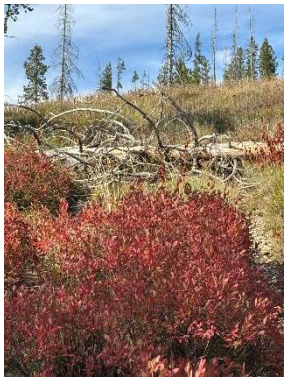




Condition rating: 1. Volunteers reopened and cleared this section in summer 2026, and it is in good condition; Raddon also rates it a 1. Chad's July hike measured 3.2 miles with about 880 feet of climbing, and Raddon lists it at 2.7 miles. What's missing is trail markers. Cody noted that the Sinque Hole trailhead needs a trail marker, that the trail signs at the Smoking Place trailhead need replacing, and that an old road cut to Indian Grave Peak joins about halfway and should be marked. Raddon recommends trailhead signs at Smoking Place, the Meadows entrance and Sinque Hole, plus junction signs where the Meadows trail leaves and rejoins.

RECOMMENDATION. Only minor cleanup in 2027. The stretch from 13 Mile through Sinque Hole is an excellent volunteer project for installing trail markers.

Bears Oil and Roots / Spring Hill Mountain (eastbound)





Condition rating: 3–4. The Bears Oil and Roots trail sign needs attention, and the trail across the Spring Hill Mountain ridge, from the old sign location to the new one, needs cutting through heavy downfall. Chad Jones has good photos of this area. Raddon notes that the 2015 fire cleared heavy brush but made the old trails harder to see, and that people keep driving the 1950s fire-tractor track up the west ridge. He rates FS 566 to Spring Mountain a 5.

RECOMMENDATION. A weekend project for experienced volunteers with a sawyer.

Dry Camp to No-See-Um Meadows







Condition rating: 4–5. The trail is there but completely buried; Wayne and Cody marked it with green flagging. West of oking Place, the ridgeline could carry the trail off the road, and old tread with older pink flagging comes

up off the road at one point. Farther on are the Green Sward camp marker and the posts where the trail crosses Road 500. Old log cuts from earlier work still show the line toward Dry Camp, but the downfall is heavy; in Cody's words, it "would require multiple days with saw teams." Near Dry Camp he found a very old sign post of unknown purpose, possibly one of the early Forest Service campsite posts.

Raddon rates Bald Mountain to Smoking Place and Dry Camp to Bald Mountain 4–5, noting that the road took out the trail in places and that a user-built trail has formed across the top of Bald Mountain. Before LCTA's recent clearing, the No-See-Um Ridge section to Dry Camp had last been cut out in the late 2010s. The exact location of Dry Camp is still debated among researchers.

Spirit Revival





Condition rating: 1. The significant tree downfall along this trail was recently cleared by Lewis & Clark Trail Adventures, and the trail to Upper Spirit Revival is easily passable. Trail post #10 marks the route, and a post marked with both Lewis and Clark and Nez Perce trail triangles stands at the No-See-Um Ridge trailhead. The reward at the top is a rock outcrop and, on a clear day, a view to the Weippe Prairie, one of the most moving Lewis and Clark moments on the route.

Laurie considers Spirit Revival Ridge the most remarkable section of the trail. It has three access points with a clear sign where they meet: a longer hike that loops back to the road farther west, a shorter return to the road, and a trail west to Sherman Saddle. Chad's loop from the trailhead took about an hour and a half, which makes it a comfortable half-day outing. All three access points are in good shape and may need only routine annual maintenance, along with renewed, clear trail markers and signs, as on the rest of the route.

> **RECOMMENDATION.** Routine annual maintenance to keep the trail open, and the clearer trail markers Laurie recommends.

No-See-Um Meadows via Sherman Creek to Wilderness Gateway

Condition rating: 1. Only minor cutting is needed, though new winter downfall is likely. Trail cleared August 2026 by Lewis & Clark Trail Adventures crew. This is a great route down to the Lochsa River and Highway 12, and it was used for guided trips all summer in 2026.

RECOMMENDATION. Updated, clearer trail markers.

Spirit Revival to Sherman Saddle


Hungery Creek

Condition rating: 5. We found no trail or tread.

RECOMMENDATION. More scouting, followed by substantial trail work.

Sherman Saddle to Sherman Peak

Condition rating: not located (Raddon rates it 2). We did not find a trail here unless it follows the fork that drops around Liz Butte meadow. Raddon describes a trail not shown on any map that climbs about 700 feet in two switchbacks on the northwest side of Sherman Peak, with trailhead parking on the south side of the road just east of the Liz Butte Road junction.

RECOMMENDATION. Scout it using Raddon's description, then mark it.

Sherman Saddle to Willow Ridge

Condition rating: 2–3. Cody walked about 2.6 miles out and back west of Sherman Saddle. There are frequent downed logs, but the tread is well established and easy to follow, with thicker brush farther on. Some posts remain, including an old sign post Cody photographed, but the trail markers need work. Raddon rates the Willow Ridge Trail to Sherman Saddle a 3: the road took out more than a quarter mile of trail, the start on the south side of the road is easy to miss, and a 15-year-old burn keeps dropping trees on the steep descent.

RECOMMENDATION. Have a crew hike through to the next junction, clearing as they go, and replace the trail markers.

Willow Ridge to Hungery Creek







Condition rating: 5. There is no trail all the way down, including the Road 485 junction and Horsesteak Meadow. Drew marked possible historic tread west of Willow Ridge that should be checked on the next trip. Driving FS 485 near Hungery Creek Trail 69, Cody found no tread or markers along the road and suggests scouting by side-by-side or ATV, since the road is narrow. Laurie sees Sherman Saddle to Willow Ridge to Hungery Creek as an essential connector and plans to hike it herself.

RECOMMENDATION. A multi-day paid crew to scout and clear.

Hungery Creek area (Portable Soup, Jerusalem Artichoke camps)

Condition rating: 5. This is remote backcountry, the expedition's movements here are complicated, and we found nothing on the ground. Whether any of it falls within designated wilderness or roadless areas, which would limit work to crosscut saws and hand tools, still needs to be checked with the Forest Service.

Raddon's guide explains that the expedition's route between Bald Mountain and Fish Creek is still disputed. At least four routes have been proposed: Space's via Willow Ridge, Russell's via Bowl Butte, the Eastmans' via No-See-Um and Pagoda Ridges, and Raddon's own via Fish Creek. Hungery Creek Trail 69 has no bridge at the creek and is hard to follow at Horsesteak Meadow, and the five campsites along the creek are unmarked. Nez Perce cultural resource staff regard Fish Creek as the route, and a Fish Creek trail would be costly and unlikely to clear environmental review because of salmon habitat. Laurie notes that from Hungery Creek the route climbs the draw to the FS 485/500 junction, which needs a full survey and marking, and then roughly follows Road 500 to the top of the Full Stomach Trail.

RECOMMENDATION. Settle the route question with the Nez Perce Tribe and Forest Service heritage staff before committing funds to construction, then scout and mark the route.

Full Stomach Camp, Trail #25, Dollar Creek

Condition rating: 1 for the upper portion, then 5. The Full Stomach Trail runs from Road 500 down to Eldorado and Dollar Creeks. A Lewis & Clark Trail Alliance work group that included Richard Hunt cleared the top 1.5 miles in June 2026. Below that, downfall and debris erase both the tread and the direction of travel. Raddon calls it "never a good trail," and the campsite itself, about halfway down, is unmarked. Below the trail, the route is supposed to follow Road 500 to Salmon Trout Camp, but no trail exists there.

RECOMMENDATION. Paid sawyers and trail builders, with crews working from the top and bottom; likely a one- to two-day job. The lower half also needs marking and a survey from the bottom.

Small Prairie to Lewis and Clark Grove (Eldorado Ridge)

Condition rating: 3–4. The trail crosses Road 500 several times near Small Prairie and Salmon Trout Camp, without posts or tread in places, and drops toward Syringa where Road 500 ends. Across the road from Small Prairie Camp, the trail climbs and soon splits. One branch is said to cross back over the road toward Salmon Trout and the Full Stomach Trail, but Laurie could not find the crossing. The other stays on that side of the road and ends, clearly marked, where Road 500 turns toward Canyon Junction; its interior is unknown.

The main trail runs about 4¼ miles to Lewis and Clark Grove. It is clearly marked, and at the midpoint, reached by the Eldorado Ridge Road, the tread and flagging are excellent. Cody found it well established and likely open to the Grove without major tread work, though Drew rated parts of it 2 to 4 with some downfall. Several old trail markers along the way are worn or damaged and need replacing, including a post at Eldorado Creek that has been shot up.

At the Grove end, a bridge is half collapsed and needs to be replaced for safety (46.29691, -115.71120). Cody Dudgeon recorded it and may have photos. It is likely the bridge near Clark's Tree, where the expedition hung food and which is well marked. From here the route continues toward Weippe by way of Musselshell camp and creek, which the Alliance looked at in 2026.

> **RECOMMENDATION.** An excellent volunteer section for clearing and new trail markers. The bridge will need professional help.

Lewis and Clark Grove to Pheasant Camp

Condition rating: 1. This section was cleared on the first day of the Alliance's 2026 volunteer project. The trail from the Grove over the ridge to the Lolo Creek trailhead on FS 100, with its pullout and pit toilets, is clear and in excellent shape. Pheasant Camp, where the main party camped on September 21, 1805, can be reached by the bridge across Lolo Creek. Recent researchers believe the historic trail ran slightly north of today's Trail #25 (Raddon).

> **RECOMMENDATION.** Routine annual maintenance.

Pheasant Camp to Weippe Prairie







Condition rating: not assessed. We did not assess this segment in 2026 and have left it for a future trip. Pheasant Camp has a clear sign, and from there the expedition could see Browns Ridge, which they followed to the Weippe Prairie.

3.3 Comparison with the Lolo Reconnected condition survey (Raddon, 2026)

Where our route overlaps Raddon's ridgeline survey, the two assessments agree within one rating point on every segment but one. The exception is Sherman Saddle to Sherman Peak, where Raddon describes an unmapped trail that the team did not locate.

Our segment	Team rating	Raddon leg	Raddon rating	Notes
Glade Creek to Colt Killed Creek	5	16–17 (7.5 mi)	5	Agree; USFS holds rights-of-way on private parcels

Our segment	Team rating	Raddon leg	Raddon rating	Notes
Snowbank, 13 Mile, Rocky Point	3–5	14B–15	4–5	Agree
Snowbank to Cayuse Junction	5	14A–B	4–5	Agree
Indian Post Office to Cayuse Junction	5	12–13 (8.5 mi)	4–5	Agree; ~4 mi of old tread likely recoverable
Lonesome Cove to Howard Camp (via Moon Saddle)	5	11 (5.0 mi)	4–5	Agree; Moon Saddle to Post Office maintained by tribal members
Howard Camp to Sinque Hole	Unclear	9–10 (5.2 mi)	3–5	Raddon proposes trail above the road
Sinque Hole to Smoking Place	1	8 (2.7 mi)	1	Exact match; both call for signage
Bears Oil and Roots / Spring Mountain	3–4	12B	5	Raddon rates lower; confirm in 2027
Smoking Place to Dry Camp	4–5	6C–7 (8.1 mi)	4–5	Agree
No-See-Um Ridge / Dry Camp area	1	6B (1.8 mi)	3–5	Recently cleared by LCTA; Raddon rates 3–5
Sherman Saddle to Sherman Peak	Not located	5D–E (3.8 mi)	2–3	Differs; scout using Raddon's description
Sherman Saddle to Willow Ridge	2–3	5C (0.9 mi)	3	Agree

Raddon's Legs 1–4 (Musselshell Meadows to Deep Saddle) and Leg 18 (Glade Creek to Lee Creek Campground) lie outside our route. They are summarized in Appendix C.

We were unable to reach the Musselshell Meadows area during the assessment because of a major temporary road closure. The Lewis & Clark Trail Alliance saw at least part of this area during its summer 2026 work.

4. Recommendations

We have grouped our recommendations by the kind of crew and funding each needs, so that volunteer projects can be scheduled right away while funding is sought for paid crews and partnership work.

4.1 Trail markers and segment signs (volunteer)

The interpretive signs along the corridor are in good condition and were well maintained through 2026. What the trail lacks is basic route marking: posts and blazes, junction markers, and signs naming each segment and its length. We recommend a consistent marker plan for the whole corridor, developed with the Forest Service, to replace missing and worn posts and to make the junctions with Road 500 and private roads clear. Priority locations:

- Lolo Pass and the Glade Creek connector
- Colt Killed Creek and White Sand Creek
- The Powell Ranger Station and Lochsa Lodge entrances, including the Bicentennial trail start at Powell Campground
- The Highway 12 crossing, the Wendover cabin and the Wendover trailhead
- 13 Mile Camp to Imnamatnoon Junction, and the Road 500 crossings east of 13 Mile Camp
- 13 Mile through Sinque Hole, our top volunteer marker project, including trailhead signs at Smoking Place, the Meadows entrance and Sinque Hole, and junction signs on the Meadows trail
- The Spirit Revival Ridge access points and Lower Spirit Revival at Wilderness Gateway
- The Sherman Peak trailhead near the Liz Butte Road junction
- Bears Oil and Roots, Willow Ridge, and the Small Prairie to Lewis and Clark Grove trail

4.2 Volunteer crew projects (ready for 2027)

Project	Scope	Est. duration	Crew
Glade Creek connector	Rake out tread and light logout, about 1/8 mile	Half day	Volunteer
White Sand Creek to Wendover	Brushing, about 12 tree cuts, trail markers	One afternoon	Volunteer
Wendover Ridge entrance bridge	Minor safety improvements or updates to the new bridge	About 1 day	Volunteers with carpentry skills; USFS approval
13 Mile Camp to Imnamatnoon Junction	Hike the interior; light maintenance and trail markers if passable	About 1 day	Volunteer
Bears Oil and Roots / Spring Hill ridge	Logout and trail markers between the old and new sign locations	2 days	Skilled volunteers with a certified sawyer
Small Prairie to Lewis and Clark Grove (about 4¼ mi)	Clearing and trail markers from both ends and the Eldorado Ridge Road midpoint; look for the missing branch toward Salmon Trout	1–2 days	Volunteer

4.3 Professional trail crew projects (funding requested)

Project	Scope	Est. duration
Bald Mountain to Dry Camp and No-See-Um Meadows	Historic tread is present and was once open (last cut out in the late 2010s); logout and tread reconstruction led by a guide or archaeologist	1–2 weeks
13 Mile Camp east to Rocky Point Lookout and 21 Mile	Survey and mark the gap between the tribal section and the flagged route to the lookout; sawyers; coordinate with the Nez Perce Tribe	Multi-day
Full Stomach Camp	Mark and log out the lower trail, with crews working from the top and bottom	1–2 days
Hungery Creek to FS 485/500 junction	Full survey and marking once the route question is settled	Several days
Indian Post Office to Lonesome Cove and Howard Camp	Locate and build trail along the ridge by way of Moon Saddle, tying into the tribally maintained Nee-Me-Poo section	Multi-day
Sinque Hole to Saddle Camp	Build about 2.2 miles of trail above the road, following Raddon's proposed alignment	Multi-day
Indian Post Office to Cayuse Junction	Flag and map about 8.5 miles of old tread, then recover about 4 miles and build new where needed	Multi-day survey, then construction
Willow Ridge to Hungery Creek (Road 485 junction, Horsesteak Meadow)	Route survey and clearing once the route question is settled	Several days
Bridge at Lewis and Clark Grove	Engineered replacement of the half-collapsed bridge (46.29691, -115.71120); a safety and access priority	To be scoped with USFS
Bears Oil and Roots	Certified sawyer support	1 day

Cost estimates will follow once crew rates and Forest Service requirements are known.

Once paid crews have finished the heavy work, such as chainsaw logout and clearing large downfall, these segments open up good opportunities for volunteers. Volunteer groups could follow behind to clean up the tread, define the trail and add trail markers, bringing each section up to a condition rating of 1 over the longer term.

4.4 Partnerships

Completing the corridor will take a partnership among the Forest Service, the Lewis & Clark Trail Alliance, tribal partners, outfitters, volunteer groups and landowners.

- **U.S. Forest Service.** Project approval, heritage review, sawyer certification, trail marker standards and Road 500 access. The agency also holds the right-of-way records for the private parcels between Glade Creek, Crooked Fork and 13 Mile, and could share the cost of paid crews through agreements.
- **Nez Perce Tribe.** Tribal members reopened and maintain the Moon Saddle to Indian Post Office section and parts of Saddle Camp to Howard Camp. Laurie also saw tribal work near Musselshell, on the ridge above Lonesome Cove toward Howard Camp, and between 13 Mile and Rocky Point, where the Tribe has flagged and cut trail. We would like to learn what work is planned, ask tribal cultural resource staff about the Hungery Creek and Fish Creek

question, and explore a joint Nee-Me-Poo and Lewis and Clark effort. Richard Hunt is currently leading this follow-up.

- **Lolo Reconnected.** Work directly with Chuck Raddon's survey toward the shared goal of more than 100 miles of open trail.
- **Idaho Trails Association and conservation corps programs.** Find out who has been working near 13 Mile and Rocky Point, and coordinate volunteer days. A conservation corps crew may also have built the new bridge at the Wendover Ridge trailhead entrance; this still needs to be confirmed.
- **Private landowners.** Access agreements where checkerboard ownership breaks up the historic route near Glade Creek, Powell and Section 21 at 13 Mile.
- **Lochsa Lodge and local outfitters.** Help promote the trail and look after the most accessible trailheads.

4.5 Road 500 access and annual maintenance

Road 500 is how we reach nearly every segment, and recent windstorms have dropped thousands of trees across it. Keeping it open should stay a priority. We also recommend an annual spring cleanup of the segments restored in 2026, namely Wendover Ridge, Sinque Hole to Smoking Place, Dry Camp to Upper Spirit Revival, Lower Spirit Revival, and Lewis and Clark Grove to Pheasant Camp, so that work isn't lost.

A word on the road itself: Road 500 is not for the faint of heart. It is a rough, primitive route that can be extremely difficult to travel, and it is suited only to advanced, skilled drivers. Washouts and downed trees regularly make sections hard to pass, and conditions can change from one trip to the next. Keeping the road open depends on continued, significant support from organizations, private individuals and the Forest Service alike, and that work is always much appreciated by everyone who relies on the road to reach the trail.

4.6 Long-term goal: a reconnected Lolo Trail

The long-term goal is a continuous, well-marked trail from Lolo Pass to the Weippe Prairie that follows the historic route as closely as land ownership allows. The main gaps are:

- Glade Creek to Colt Killed Creek, which depends on landowner, Forest Service and tribal cooperation
- Snowbank to Cayuse Junction, extending the restored Wendover Ridge trail westward
- Lonesome Cove to Howard Camp
- Hungery Creek, where the historic route needs to be settled with the Nez Perce Tribe and Forest Service heritage staff before construction
- The Road 500 corridor, where an approach is needed for when the trail runs alongside the road and when the road is the route

Closing these gaps will take several years of volunteer work, paid crews, agency support and tribal partnership.

4.7 Shared data and standards

As Raddon points out, Forest Service funding has not been enough to reopen the trail or even to map and catalog it, so much of that work has fallen to volunteers. We recommend that the Alliance, Lolo Reconnected and the Forest Service:

- use one condition rating scale, based on Raddon's definitions;
- cross-reference this report's segments to Raddon's 18 legs; and
- keep a single, regularly updated map and condition record for the whole corridor, with GPS points and photos.

The trail and sign inventory we prepared for the National Park Service's Lewis and Clark National Historic Trail office uses the same 1–5 scale and is a good place to start.

5. Conclusion

We came away from this assessment with a clear picture of what exists on Trail #25 today and what does not. The 2026 volunteer season has already made a real difference on Wendover Ridge, Sinque Hole to Smoking Place, and Lewis and Clark Grove to Pheasant Camp, and Chuck Raddon's independent survey reached the same conclusions as ours on nearly every segment where the two overlap.

Our three main recommendations:

1. Put trail markers and segment signs in place across the corridor. It is the most visible improvement for anyone using the trail, and volunteers can do most of it.
2. Keep Road 500 open, and maintain the segments restored this year.
3. Build a partnership with the Forest Service, the Nez Perce Tribe, the Idaho Trails Association and others, and fund paid crews for the segments volunteers cannot safely or effectively take on.

With that support, a reconnected Lolo Trail is within reach. We are grateful for the chance to walk this route and share what we found, and we would be glad to talk through any of these projects in more detail.

6. References and Appendices

References

- Raddon, Charles. *The Lolo Trail Riding and Hiking Trail, Nee-Me-Poo National Historic Trail: Description and Existing Physical Condition*. Prepared by Lolo Reconnected. Edit date September 8, 2026.
- Raddon, Charles. *A History Buff's Guide to the Lolo Trail Corridor*. Edited by Kristopher K. Townsend. First printing, June 2026.
- Space, Ralph S. *The Lolo Trail*. USDA Forest Service, 1962; later editions 1970 and 2001. (Cited in Raddon.)
- Russell, Stephen. Lolo Trail cartography and trail research, trailresearch.org. (Cited in Raddon.)
- Broncheau-McFarland, Sandra. *Nez Perce (Nee-Me-Poo) National Historic Trail: Historic and Administrative Context*. USDA Forest Service, 2016. (Cited in Raddon.)
- Lewis & Clark Trail Adventures. 2026 field data: onX exports (Drew Reeve, Cody Dudgeon) and Strava tracks (Chad Jones).

Appendices

- Appendix A: Field photographs
- Appendix B: Field GPS waypoints and tracks (Drew Reeve and Cody Dudgeon, onX; Chad Jones, Strava)
- Appendix C: Lolo Reconnected condition survey summary (Raddon, 2026)
- Appendix D: Source files (onX KML exports and Strava GPX tracks), available on request
- Appendix E: Lolo Trail and Sign Inventory Worksheet, prepared for the National Park Service Lewis and Clark National Historic Trail (Ryan M. Cooper, Geographer), provided as a separate Excel file

Appendix A: Field photographs

Two photographs of the team appear in Sections 1 and 2. Many more photographs from the assessment are held by the team members who took them and are available on request. Likely sources for the key locations:

- Wendover Ridge entrance bridge: Drew Reeve
- Bears Oil and Roots and the Spring Hill Mountain ridge; Snowbank to Cayuse Junction: Chad Jones
- Old sign post west of Sherman Saddle; the collapsed bridge at Lewis and Clark Grove: Cody Dudgeon
- Spirit Revival Ridge and the 13 Mile Camp area: Laurie Rudd

Appendix B: Field GPS waypoints (onX, September 24–27, 2026)

Drew Reeve. Named or annotated waypoints, in the order recorded. All 57 waypoints, with their original labels, are on the *onX Waypoints (Reeve)* tab of the inventory worksheet. Coordinates are decimal degrees (WGS84).

Date / time	Location and field note	Segment	GPS	Elev. (ft)
09/24 09:54	Lolo Pass	LCTA-01	46.63496, -114.57820	5,233
09/24 10:03	Glade Creek Trailhead camp	LCTA-01	46.62813, -114.57559	5,239
09/24 10:13	Glade Creek overlook camp; start of day-1 track	LCTA-02	46.62204, -114.57552	5,183
09/24 10:50	Old Glade Creek trailhead	LCTA-01	46.62149, -114.57612	5,230
09/24 11:37	Near Crooked Fork: parcel that appeared to be for sale	LCTA-02	46.58032, -114.60158	4,169
09/24 11:39	Near Crooked Fork: houses and construction on private land	LCTA-02	46.57824, -114.60445	4,007
09/24 11:52	Colt Killed Creek, head of Lochsa River	LCTA-02/03	46.50880, -114.68045	3,447
09/24 13:14	Gated private road near mapped trail: "Close to trail on map, well developed private road, gated access"	LCTA-02	46.51991, -114.64703	4,261
09/24 13:42	Trail #25 near Colt Killed Creek	LCTA-03	46.50843, -114.68724	3,455
09/24 14:02	Trail #25: "need signage, good solid trail"	LCTA-03	46.51322, -114.69618	3,625
09/24 14:19	Trail #25: "Trail is a 1, need signage at end"	LCTA-03	46.50718, -114.68508	3,442
09/24 14:37	Wendover Ridge Trailhead	LCTA-04/05	46.51097, -114.78260	3,298
09/24 14:54	Wendover cabin: "Need signage?"	LCTA-04	46.50878, -114.77135	3,299
09/24 15:23	Trail crossing Hwy 12: "trail needs work, 2ish"	LCTA-04	46.51634, -114.74987	3,328
09/24 15:28	Trail #25 west of Powell	LCTA-04	46.51012, -114.71283	3,404
09/24 15:54	Powell	LCTA-03/04	46.51336, -114.71935	3,473
09/24 16:12	13 Mile Camp at Powell Junction	LCTA-06	46.57908, -114.71857	5,874
09/24 16:56	Top of Wendover Ridge Trail at Road 500	LCTA-05	46.57952, -114.81542	6,574
09/24	Bears Oil and Roots	LCTA-08	46.57193, -	6,229

Date / time	Location and field note	Segment	GPS	Elev. (ft)
17:52			114.90676	
09/24 17:56	Bears Oil and Roots, end of trail	LCTA-08	46.57173, -114.90783	6,155
09/24 17:57	Bears Oil and Roots	LCTA-08	46.57026, -114.90733	6,061
09/25 07:47	Team camp near FS 566 / Road 500 junction	—	46.55213, -114.95063	6,669
09/25 08:07	Indian Post Office	LCTA-09	46.54626, -114.98809	6,936
09/25 08:26	Lonesome Cove Camp, near the Indian Post Office	LCTA-09	46.54821, -114.99241	6,622
09/25 08:48	Lonesome Cove cut trail	LCTA-09	46.54710, -114.99242	6,669
09/25 09:02	Indian Post Office lake viewpoint	LCTA-09	46.53980, -114.98751	6,451
09/25 09:16	Moon Saddle	LCTA-09/10	46.53631, -115.01572	6,101
09/25 09:39	Howard Camp	LCTA-10/11	46.53186, -115.06694	6,116
09/25 11:16	No-See-Um Butte trailhead	LCTA-15	46.42651, -115.29333	5,964
09/25 11:22	Spirit Revival trailhead	LCTA-17	46.42319, -115.31652	5,974
09/25 11:45	"Big fork" on Spirit Revival route	LCTA-15/17	46.41892, -115.32985	6,132
09/25 13:06	Alternate route to Spirit Revival	LCTA-15/17	46.42078, -115.32674	6,000
09/25 13:07	Alternate route to Spirit Revival: "Less tree fall to go through"	LCTA-15/17	46.42560, -115.32631	6,004
09/25 13:39	Sherman Saddle (labeled "Willow Ridge, Deep Saddle"; coordinates match Sherman Saddle)	LCTA-17/18/19	46.41749, -115.36741	4,740
09/25 14:23	Possible historic Lewis and Clark tread west of Willow Ridge	LCTA-20	46.42502, -115.42171	5,482
09/26 09:34	Near Lewis and Clark Grove	LCTA-24	46.28895, -115.71731	3,165
09/26 10:36	Eldorado Ridge Road midpoint: "2,3,4 trail conditions both directions, some downfall, but good tread, needs new signage"	LCTA-23	46.29788, -115.67943	4,134
09/26 11:08	Small Prairie Camp trailhead	LCTA-23	46.28475, -115.66291	3,519
09/26 11:21	Eldorado Creek: Full Stomach Trail #25 trailhead	LCTA-22	46.29925, -115.64622	3,543

Drew's four daily tracks total about 296 miles, mostly driving on Road 500 and the highways. The only one made entirely on foot is a 2.0-mile walk on September 27 from the Highway 12 crossing to the Wendover cabin.

Cody Dudgeon. Annotated waypoints in the order recorded, leaving out minor down-log points. All 60 waypoints and 24 tracks are on the *onX Waypoints (Dudgeon)* tab of the inventory worksheet.

Date / time	Location and field note	Segment	GPS	Elev. (ft)
09/25 09:46	Lonesome Cove Camp	LCTA-09	46.54787, -114.99297	6,661
09/25 09:51	Cutoff from Nee-Me-Poo Trail to Lonesome Cove	LCTA-09	46.54715, -114.99234	6,674
09/25 10:48	Near Howard Camp: possible Lewis and Clark route, no trail found	LCTA-10/11	46.54262, -115.06144	6,035
09/25 11:35	Sinque Hole Trailhead: needs trail marker	LCTA-12/13	46.50913, -115.13808	5,869
09/25 11:49	Old road cut to Indian Grave Peak meets trail: needs marker	LCTA-13	46.49536, -115.15319	6,193
09/25 11:54	Smoking Place Trailhead: signage needs replacing	LCTA-13/14	46.48379, -115.15748	6,364
09/25 12:03	Ridgeline west of Smoking Place: potential off-road trail	LCTA-14	46.47791, -115.16412	6,454
09/25 12:09	Old tread with older pink flagging where trail meets road	LCTA-14	46.47142, -115.17024	6,383
09/25 12:13	Ridgeline could be cut south of road	LCTA-14	46.46821, -115.17474	6,541
09/25 12:37	Green Sward: camp marker and interpretive sign	LCTA-14	46.45134, -115.24081	6,213
09/25 12:51	West of Bald Mountain: heavy downfall, saw team needed	LCTA-14	46.44906, -115.25520	6,020
09/25 13:00	Trail post where trail crosses road	LCTA-14	46.43996, -115.26688	5,967
09/25 13:01	Trail post, upper ridgeline north of road	LCTA-14	46.43860, -115.26953	6,000
09/25 13:02	Trail post where trail crosses road	LCTA-14	46.43827, -115.27074	6,026
09/25 13:03	Trail post; trail continues south around ridgeline	LCTA-14	46.43840, -115.27120	6,029
09/25 13:07	Very old historic sign post near Dry Camp; heavy downfall, "multiple days with saw teams"	LCTA-14/15	46.43654, -115.27669	6,064
09/25 13:12	Trail post #10; heavy downfall	LCTA-15	46.43115, -115.28477	5,919
09/25 13:15	Trail post heading off-road to southwest	LCTA-15	46.42892, -115.28856	5,933

Date / time	Location and field note	Segment	GPS	Elev. (ft)
09/25 13:17	Post with Lewis and Clark and Nez Perce trail triangles, No-See-Um Ridge trailhead	LCTA-15	46.42602, -115.29273	6,021
09/25 13:26	Lewis and Clark trail location per onX, near Spirit Revival trailhead	LCTA-17	46.42047, -115.31211	6,037
09/25 14:18	West of Sherman Saddle: several down logs, tread visible	LCTA-19	46.42069, -115.37530	5,246
09/25 14:32	Tread followable, denser vegetation, few down trees	LCTA-19	46.42430, -115.38280	5,560
09/25 14:39	Old sign post (photographed); tread well established	LCTA-19	46.42602, -115.38600	5,710
09/25 16:56	Top of Full Stomach Trail #25 near FS 500: cleared ~1.5 mi, then tread lost	LCTA-22	46.33814, -115.60309	4,816
09/26 09:36	Lolo Creek Trailhead, FS 100: trail clear, maintained June 2026	LCTA-24	46.29552, -115.74877	2,891
09/26 09:47	Lewis and Clark Grove trailhead, trail to Lolo Creek Trailhead	LCTA-24	46.29675, -115.71369	3,243
09/26 09:59	Sign post needs replacing, Lewis and Clark Grove	LCTA-23/24	46.29678, -115.71177	3,246
09/26 10:01	**Bridge half collapsed**, Grove end of trail to Small Prairie (likely the Clark's Tree bridge)	LCTA-23	46.29691, -115.71120	3,266
09/26 10:37	Eldorado Ridge Road midpoint: tread visible and maintained-looking	LCTA-23	46.29738, -115.67862	4,164
09/26 11:09	Small Prairie Camp trailhead marker: old but readable	LCTA-23	46.28480, -115.66292	3,518
09/26 11:22	Eldorado Creek trailhead: sign post old and shot up	LCTA-22/23	46.29939, -115.64633	3,545
09/27 09:59	Bottom of Full Stomach Trail #25, Eldorado Creek: tread indistinguishable	LCTA-22	46.29927, -115.64481	3,551
09/27 11:05	Trail #25 west of Powell: down log	LCTA-04	46.51312, -114.72925	3,388
09/27 11:18	Trail splits and meets road; side-cut trail debris-covered	LCTA-04	46.51735, -114.74008	—
09/27 11:21	Tread visible to here; heavy downfall beyond	LCTA-04	46.51674, -114.74252	3,343
09/27 11:31	Trail crosses Hwy 12 to two-track road cut	LCTA-04	46.51654, -114.75024	3,341
09/27 11:33	Two-track behind gate	LCTA-04	46.51689, -114.75058	3,352
09/27 12:13	Single-track split with trail marker sign ~30 ft from road	LCTA-04	46.51746, -114.75987	3,520
09/27 12:25	Trail crosses road to creek bridge toward Wendover	LCTA-04	46.51261, -114.76292	3,321

Date / time	Location and field note	Segment	GPS	Elev. (ft)
09/27 12:31	Downed trees; tread visible	LCTA-04	46.51084, -114.76294	3,337
09/27 12:42	Road crossing to campground at Wendover cabin; no signs westward	LCTA-04	46.50904, -114.77067	3,302

Cody's walked tracks include 13 Mile Camp and the ridgeline east to Rocky Point (September 24), the route from the Indian Post Office to Lonesome Cove Camp (0.45 mi), a 2.6-mile out-and-back west of Sherman Saddle, and Powell to the Wendover cabin (3.6 mi). His September 26 FS 485 track near Hungery Creek (4.3 mi) was driven.

Chad Jones: Strava hike tracks, with details on the *Strava Tracks (Jones)* tab of the inventory worksheet.

Date	Hike	Segment	Distance (mi)	Elev. gain (ft)	Elapsed time
07/30	Wendover Ridge, trailhead to Road 500	LCTA-05	~9 (GPS)	—	~7 h 10 min
07/31	Sinque Hole to Smoking Place	LCTA-13	3.2	879	2 h 4 min
09/25	Lonesome Cove Camp loop from Indian Post Office	LCTA-09	1.2	351	53 min
09/25	Spirit Revival Ridge loop	LCTA-15/17	~3.1 (GPS)	—	1 h 34 min

Appendix C: Lolo Reconnected condition survey summary (Raddon, 2026)

The Nee-Me-Poo ridgeline route, Musselshell Meadows to Lee Creek Campground, totals about 97.5 miles in 18 legs. Conditions use Raddon's 1–5 scale.

Leg	From – to	Miles	Condition	Notes
1	Musselshell Meadows – Camp Martin	12.4	1	Trailhead sign and toilet; spring at Camp Martin
2	Camp Martin – Beaverdam Saddle	4.7	2	2014 fire; long-term downfall
3	Beaverdam Saddle – Weitas Meadows	9.0	2–3	~2 mi lost under road; last maintained around Bicentennial
4	Weitas Meadows – Deep Saddle	5.8	1–5	Puncheon bridge maintained by Nez Perce tribal members; USGS map errors near Bowl Butte
5	Deep Saddle – No-See-Um Meadows	6.0	2–5	Includes Willow Ridge, Sherman Saddle and Sherman Peak trails
6	No-See-Um Meadows – Bald Mountain	5.0	2–5	Frequent road crossings; last cut out late 2010s
7	Bald Mountain – Smoking Place sign	5.7	4–5	Road removed trail in places
8	Smoking Place – Sinque Hole Trailhead	2.7	1	Cut out; no directional signs
9	Sinque Hole Trailhead – Saddle Camp	2.2	5	Three above-road sections proposed
10	Saddle Camp – Howard Camp	3.0	3–5	Partly opened by tribal members; needs flagging
11	Howard Camp – Indian Post Office	5.0	4–5	Moon Saddle to Post Office reopened by tribal members

Leg	From – to	Miles	Condition	Notes
12	Indian Post Office – Spring Mountain	5.0	5	~4 mi likely recoverable
13	Spring Mountain – Cayuse Junction	3.5	4–5	Flag, map, then decide
14	Cayuse Junction – Imnamatnoon Likoolam Saddle	9.0	4–5	Includes Snowbank Camp and Lost Lakes Trailhead
15	Imnamatnoon Likoolam Saddle – Rocky Point Lookout	4.0	4–5	Private Section 21 with USFS right-of-way
16	Rocky Point Lookout – Crooked Fork	3.5	5	Unmaintained since 1930s; gated Road 500 an option
17	Crooked Fork – Glade Creek	4.0	5	Checkerboard ownership; USFS rights-of-way
18	Glade Creek – Lee Creek Campground	7.0	1	Multiple trails; route clarity needed